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Lawsuit To Stop Racist Placement In Schools

BIASED I.Q. TESTS LABEL BLACK CHILDREN MENTALLY RETARDED



A group of Black parents in San Francisco has filed suit against the State Department of Education for using racially- and culturally-biased I.Q. tests to place Black children in classes for the mentally retarded.

(San Francisco, Calif.) - A major class action lawsuit challenging the use of culturally and racially-biased I.Q. tests to place Black elementary students in classes for the mentally retarded is finally going to trial on October 11.

The six-year-old lawsuit, *Larry P. vs. Riles*, will test in federal court Black parents' long-standing contention that standard I.Q. tests are biased against Blacks, and that they systematically underestimate the learning ability of Black school children.

As a result, thousands of Black children both in California and throughout the country have been subjected to a second-rate education and are forever saddled with the stigma of mental retardation.

Larry P. vs. Riles seeks relief for all Black elementary school children in California who have been wrongfully placed in classes for the so-called "educable mentally retarded" (EMR) because of individual intelligence tests.

The plaintiffs — Black children and their parents — are being represented in court by the NAACP and Public Advocates, Inc. The case will be conducted in the courtroom of federal District Court Judge Robert Peckham on the 19th floor of the Federal Building, 450 Golden Gate Avenue, San Francisco, beginning at 10:00 a.m. on Tuesday, October 11.

Specifically, the plaintiffs in *Larry P. vs. Riles* assert that I.Q. tests, such as the WISC-R and the Stanford-Binet, improperly evaluate Blacks

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